

Guidance

VAT rates on different goods and services

A list of goods and services showing which rates of VAT apply and which items are exempt or outside the scope of VAT.

From: **HM Revenue & Customs** ([/government/organisations/hm-revenue-customs](https://www.gov.uk/government/organisations/hm-revenue-customs))

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If you're [registered for VAT \(https://www.gov.uk/vat-registration\)](https://www.gov.uk/vat-registration), you have to [charge VAT \(https://www.gov.uk/vat-businesses/how-vat-works\)](https://www.gov.uk/vat-businesses/how-vat-works) when you make taxable supplies.

What qualifies and the [VAT rate \(https://www.gov.uk/vat-rates\)](https://www.gov.uk/vat-rates) you charge depends on the type of goods or services you provide.

No VAT is charged on goods or services that are:

- exempt from VAT
- outside the scope of the UK VAT system

This guide to goods and services and their VAT rates is not a complete list. You can see a [full list of VAT notices \(https://www.gov.uk/government/collections/vat-notices-alphabetical-order\)](https://www.gov.uk/government/collections/vat-notices-alphabetical-order) for goods and services not included in this guide.

VAT rate conditions

These rates may only apply if certain conditions are met, or in particular circumstances, depending on some or all of the following:

- who's providing or buying them
- where they're provided
- how they're presented for sale

- the precise nature of the goods or services
- whether you obtain the necessary evidence
- whether you [keep the right records \(https://www.gov.uk/charge-reclaim-record-vat/keeping-vat-records\)](https://www.gov.uk/charge-reclaim-record-vat/keeping-vat-records)
- whether they're provided with other goods and services

Other conditions may also apply.

There are also specific VAT rules for certain trades that affect:

- how you account for VAT
- how much you must pay
- how much you can reclaim

Find information about [VAT for builders \(https://www.gov.uk/vat-builders\)](https://www.gov.uk/vat-builders) and [VAT for charities \(https://www.gov.uk/vat-charities\)](https://www.gov.uk/vat-charities).

International trade

Goods exported outside the UK are zero-rated, subject to conditions. You can read more about [VAT on goods sent overseas \(https://www.gov.uk/guidance/vat-exports-dispatches-and-supplying-goods-abroad\)](https://www.gov.uk/guidance/vat-exports-dispatches-and-supplying-goods-abroad).

Food and drink, animals, animal feed, plants and seeds

Food and drink for human consumption is usually zero-rated but some items are always standard-rated. These include:

- catering
- alcoholic drinks
- confectionery
- crisps and savoury snacks

- hot food
- sports drinks
- hot takeaways
- ice cream
- soft drinks and mineral water

Restaurants must always charge VAT on everything eaten either on their premises or in communal areas designated for their customers to use, such as shared tables in a shopping centre or airport food courts.

In addition, restaurants and takeaway vendors must charge VAT on all hot takeaways and home deliveries, but do not need to charge VAT on cold takeaway food unless it's to be eaten in a designated area.

From 15 July 2020 to 31 March 2021, certain supplies of catering and hot takeaway food that would normally be taxable at the standard rate of VAT, will be liable to the reduced rate of 5%.

Certain animals, animal feeding products, plants and seeds also qualify for the zero rate, but only if the conditions in the following VAT notices are met. However, products packaged as pet food are standard-rated.

Find out more about:

- [food and drink in VAT Notice 701/14 \(https://www.gov.uk/guidance/food-products-and-vat-notice-70114\)](https://www.gov.uk/guidance/food-products-and-vat-notice-70114)
- [catering and take-away food in VAT Notice 709/1 \(https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/vat-notice-7091-catering-and-take-away-food\)](https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/vat-notice-7091-catering-and-take-away-food)
- [animals and animal feed in VAT Notice 701/15 \(https://www.gov.uk/guidance/animals-and-animal-food-notice-70115\)](https://www.gov.uk/guidance/animals-and-animal-food-notice-70115)
- [plants and seeds in VAT Notice 701/38 \(https://www.gov.uk/guidance/zero-rating-certain-seeds-and-plants-for-vat-notice-70138\)](https://www.gov.uk/guidance/zero-rating-certain-seeds-and-plants-for-vat-notice-70138)

Sport, leisure, culture and antiques

Sport

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Physical education and sports activities	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/45

Leisure

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Betting and gaming — including pool betting and games of chance	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/29
Bingo — including remote games played on the internet, telephone, television or radio	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/29
Lottery ticket sales	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/29
Online lottery games	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/29
Retailer commission on lottery ticket sales	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/29

Culture

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Admission charges by public authorities or eligible cultural bodies to certain cultural events such as visits to museums, art exhibitions, zoos and performances	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/47

Antiques

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Antiques, works of art or similar (as assets of historic houses) sold by private treaty to public collections	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/12
Antiques, works of art or similar (as assets of historic houses) used to settle a tax or estate duty debt with HMRC	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/12

Health, education, welfare and charities

Charities

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Admission charges by charities	Exempt	How VAT applies to charities
Advertising services for charities	0%	VAT Notice 701/58
Certain goods sold at charitable fundraising events	0%	Charity fund-raising events and VAT
Charitable fundraising events	Exempt	Charity fundraising events and VAT
Charity shops — selling donated goods	0%	Charitable donations and VAT

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Construction and sale of new buildings for a relevant charitable purpose	0%	VAT Notice 708
Energy-saving materials permanently installed in dwellings and buildings used for a relevant residential purpose providing the total cost of them (not including VAT) is not over 60% of the cost of the installation of the products (not including VAT)	5%	Energy-saving materials — supply only — are standard-rated — VAT Notice 708/6
Sponsored charitable events	Exempt	Charities and VAT
Voluntary donations to charity	Outside the scope of VAT	Donations to charities

Welfare

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Building services for disabled people	0%	Notice 701/7 VAT reliefs for disabled people
Burial or cremation of dead people, or burial at sea	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/32
Mobility aids for the elderly	5%	Mobility aids for older people
Equipment for blind or partially sighted people	0%	Equipment for blind or partially sighted people

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Equipment for disabled people	0%	Equipment for disabled people
Funeral plans written under contracts of insurance	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/36
Smoking cessation products — nicotine patches and gum	5%	Read Budget Note BN77 (PDF, 42K)
Welfare services provided by charities at significantly below cost	Outside the scope of VAT	VAT Notice 701/1
Magnetic tape adapted for recording speech for blind people together with apparatus for making and playing the adapted tape and certain low vision aids	0%	Aids for blind people

Health

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Care or medical treatment provided by a qualifying institution like a hospital, hospice or nursing home	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/31
Dispensing of prescriptions by a registered pharmacist	0%	VAT Notice 701/57
Health services provided by registered doctors, dentists, opticians, pharmacists and other health professionals	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/57

Goods or services**VAT
rate****More information**

Incontinence products

0%

[VAT Notice 701/7](#)

Maternity pads

0%

[VAT Notice 701/18](#)

Sanitary protection products

0%

[VAT Notice 701/18](#)

Low vision aids

0%

[Equipment for blind or partially sighted people](#)**Education****Goods or services****VAT
rate****More information**

Education and vocational training provided by an eligible body other than a 'private school'. Goods or services closely connected to the education provided by an eligible body like a school, college or university

Exempt

[VAT Notice 701/30](#)**Power, utilities, energy and energy saving, heating****Power**

Goods or services**VAT
rate****More information**

Electricity for domestic and residential use or for non-business use by a charity

5%

Fuel for business use is usually standard-rated — [VAT Notice 701/19](#)

Gas for domestic and residential use or for non-business use by a charity

5%

Fuel for business use is usually standard-rated — [VAT Notice 701/19](#)

Heating oil for domestic and residential use or for non-business use by a charity

5%

Fuel for business use is usually standard-rated — [VAT Notice 701/19](#)

Solid fuel for domestic and residential use or for non-business use by a charity

5%

Fuel for business use is usually standard-rated — [VAT Notice 701/19](#)**Utilities****Goods or services****VAT
rate****More information**

Cesspools, septic tanks or similar (domestic) — emptying

0%

Emptying industrial cesspools, septic tanks or similar is standard-rated — [VAT Notice 701/16](#)

Sewerage services supplied to domestic or industrial customers

0%

Sewer and drain cleaning, unblocking or maintenance is standard-rated — [VAT Notice 701/16](#)

Water supplied to households

0%

Water supplied to industrial customers is standard-rated — [VAT Notice 701/16](#)**Energy-saving materials installed in dwellings and buildings used for a relevant residential purpose**

To qualify for the reduced rate, you must be over 60 or in receipt of any of the benefits listed in [VAT Notice 708/6](https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/vat-notice-7086-energy-saving-materials) (<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/vat-notice-7086-energy-saving-materials>).

Alternatively, you may be eligible to get the reduced rate on the products if the total cost of them (not including VAT) is not over 60% of the installation of the products (not including VAT). If your products cost more than 60% of the installation, you'll only be entitled to the reduced rate on the installation.

Installed goods	VAT rate	More information
Air source heat pumps	0% (5% Northern Ireland)	VAT Notice 708/6
Boilers — wood fuelled	0% (5% Northern Ireland)	VAT Notice 708/6
Central heating and hot water controls	0% (5% Northern Ireland)	VAT Notice 708/6
Draught stripping	0% (5% Northern Ireland)	VAT Notice 708/6
Ground source heat pumps	0% (5% Northern Ireland)	VAT Notice 708/6
Insulation	0% (5% Northern Ireland)	VAT Notice 708/6
Micro combined heat and power units	0% (5% Northern Ireland)	VAT Notice 708/6
Solar panels	0% (5% Northern Ireland)	VAT Notice 708/6
Water and wind turbines	0%	VAT Notice 708/6

Heating equipment and connection of gas supply (to the extent they are grant-funded by certain funders to people aged over 60 or who are in receipt of certain benefits)

Installed goods	VAT rate	More information
Closed solid fuel fire cassettes	5%	VAT Notice 708/6
Electric dual immersion water heaters with factory-insulated hot water tanks	5%	VAT Notice 708/6
Electric storage heaters	5%	VAT Notice 708/6
Gas-fired boilers	5%	VAT Notice 708/6
Gas room heaters with thermostatic controls	5%	VAT Notice 708/6
Oil-fired boilers	5%	VAT Notice 708/6
Radiators	5%	VAT Notice 708/6
The installation, repair and maintenance of a boiler, radiators, pipework and controls forming a central heating system (including micro combined heat and power systems)	5%	VAT Notice 708/6
The installation, repair and maintenance of renewable source heating systems. This means space or water heating systems which use energy from: renewable sources, including solar, wind and hydroelectric power; or near renewable sources, including ground and air heat	5%	VAT Notice 708/6
Connection or reconnection to the mains gas supply	5%	VAT Notice 708/6

Building and construction, land and property

Building and construction

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Substantial reconstructions to protected buildings that are buildings used as a dwelling, for a relevant residential purpose or for a relevant charitable purpose	0%	VAT Notice 708
The installation of a bathroom or lavatory, constructing ramps and widening doorways or passageways for disabled people in their own home	0%	Building services for disabled people
Construction and first freehold or long leasehold sale of a new building for a relevant charitable purpose	0%	VAT Notice 708
Construction and first freehold or long leasehold sale of a new building for relevant residential purposes	0%	VAT Notice 708
Construction and first freehold or long leasehold sale of new domestic buildings	0%	VAT Notice 708
Converting existing premises by increasing the number of dwellings within the building	5%	VAT Notice 708
Renovating a dwelling that has been empty for at least 2 years	5%	VAT Notice 708
First freehold or long leasehold sale of a commercial building converted into a dwelling or dwellings	0%	VAT Notice 708
First freehold or long leasehold sale of buildings converted for relevant residential purposes	0%	VAT Notice 708

Goods or services**VAT
rate****More information**

First freehold or long leasehold sale of buildings converted for relevant charitable purposes

0%

[VAT Notice 708](#)**Land and property****Goods or services****VAT
rate****More information**

Garages or parking spaces let together with dwellings (under shorthold tenancy agreements) for permanent residential use

Exempt

Garages or facilities specially designed for parking are standard-rated —
[VAT Notice 742](#)

Parking — grant, or licence, to occupy land on which incidental parking takes place

Exempt

[VAT Notice 742](#)

Property, land and buildings — grant, or licence, to occupy land or buildings

Exempt

[VAT Notice 742](#)

Sale or long lease of a new dwelling with garage or parking space

0%

[VAT Notice 708](#)**Transport, freight, travel and vehicles****Transport**

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Aircraft repair and maintenance	0%	VAT Notice 744C

Freight

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Freight transport to or from a place outside the UK	0%	Domestic freight transport is standard-rated, unless it is the domestic leg of freight transport between the UK and another country (0%). — VAT Notice 744B
Freight containers — sale, lease or hire to a place outside the UK and the EU	0%	VAT Notice 703/1
International freight transport that takes place in the UK and its territorial waters	0%	VAT Notice 744B

Travel

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Houseboat moorings	Exempt	VAT Notice 742

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Parking spaces or garages supplied with houseboat moorings	Exempt	VAT Notice 742
Passenger transport in a vehicle, boat or aircraft that carries not less than 10 passengers	0%	VAT Notice 744A
Tolls for bridges, tunnels and roads operated by public authorities	Outside the scope of VAT	Privately-operated tolls for bridges, tunnels and roads are standard-rated — VAT Notice 700

Vehicles

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Aircraft repair and maintenance	0%	VAT Notice 744C
Airships — sale or charter	0%	VAT Notice 744C
Caravans (more than 7 metres long or more than 2.55 metres wide)	0% or 5%	Taxing holiday caravans
Civil aeroplanes — sale or charter	0%	Gliders — sale or charter — are standard-rated as are hot air balloons — VAT Notice 744C
Helicopters — sale or charter	0%	VAT Notice 744C

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Houseboats — sale or let out on hire	0%	But holiday accommodation let in a moored houseboat is standard-rated — VAT Notice 701/20
Military aeroplanes — sale or charter	0%	VAT Notice 744C
Ship repairs and maintenance	0%	VAT Notice 744C
Shipbuilding — 15 tons or over gross tonnage	0%	VAT Notice 744C

Printing, postage, publications — books, magazines and newspapers

Printing

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Brochures	0%	VAT Notice 701/10
Leaflets	0%	VAT Notice 701/10
Pamphlets	0%	VAT Notice 701/10

Postage

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Direct-mail postal services meeting all the conditions of VAT Notice 700/24 3.2 and 3.3	Outside the scope of VAT	VAT Notice 700/24
Postage, packing and delivery within the UK included in the sales contract but charged for separately, for example, mail order	The same rate as the goods being delivered or posted	Postage, packing and delivery within the UK charged as an optional extra is always standard-rated — VAT Notice 700/24
Public postal services provided by the Royal Mail under a universal service obligation	Exempt	Standard Royal Mail first and second class services for example
Other postal services that are not subject to a universal service obligation	Standard-rated	Supplies that are not subject to regulation

Publications

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Books	0%	VAT Notice 701/10
Children's painting and picture books	0%	VAT Notice 701/10
Maps and charts	0%	VAT Notice 701/10

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Magazines	0%	VAT Notice 701/10
Newspapers	0%	VAT Notice 701/10
Printed or copied music	0%	VAT Notice 701/10
Publications	0%	Some items are standard-rated such as exercise books, letterheads, posters — VAT Notice 701/10

Clothing and footwear, protective and safety equipment

Clothing and footwear

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Babywear	0%	VAT Notice 714
Children's clothes and footwear	0%	VAT Notice 714

Protective and safety equipment

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Carrycots with restraint straps	5%	VAT Notice 701/23
Children's car seats, booster seats and booster cushions	5%	VAT Notice 701/23
Children's safety seats with bare wheeled framework	5%	Prams and pushchairs are standard-rated — VAT Notice 701/23
Cycle helmets — CE marked	0%	VAT Notice 701/23
Motorcycle helmets that meet safety standards	0%	VAT Notice 701/23
Protective boots and helmets for industrial use	0%	VAT Notice 701/23

Financial services and investments, insurance

Financial services and investments

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Financial services including the issue, transfer or receipt of, or dealing with money, securities for money or orders for the payment of money	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/49

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
The granting of credit such as loans	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/49
The management of credit by the person who has granted it	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/49
The provision of the facility of instalment credit finance for example hire-purchase	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/49
The provision of qualifying financial intermediary services	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/49
The issue, transfer or dealing with a security, including shares and bonds	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/49
The operation of a current, deposit or savings account	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/49
The management of a qualifying special investment fund	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/49
Financial service supplied as a separate element but with other goods or services	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/49
Financial service supplied as part of a single supply with other goods or services	Exempt if financial service is the principal element of the supply	VAT Notice 701/49
Gold investment coins	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/21

Insurance

Goods or services	VAT rate	More information
Friendly society subscriptions for the provision of insurance	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/36
Insurance and reinsurance transactions	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/36
Insurance brokers and agents acting in an intermediary capacity	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/36
Insurance supplied as a separate element but with other goods or services	Exempt	VAT Notice 701/36
Insurance supplied as part of a single supply with other goods or services	Exempt if insurance is the principal element of the supply	VAT Notice 701/36

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